

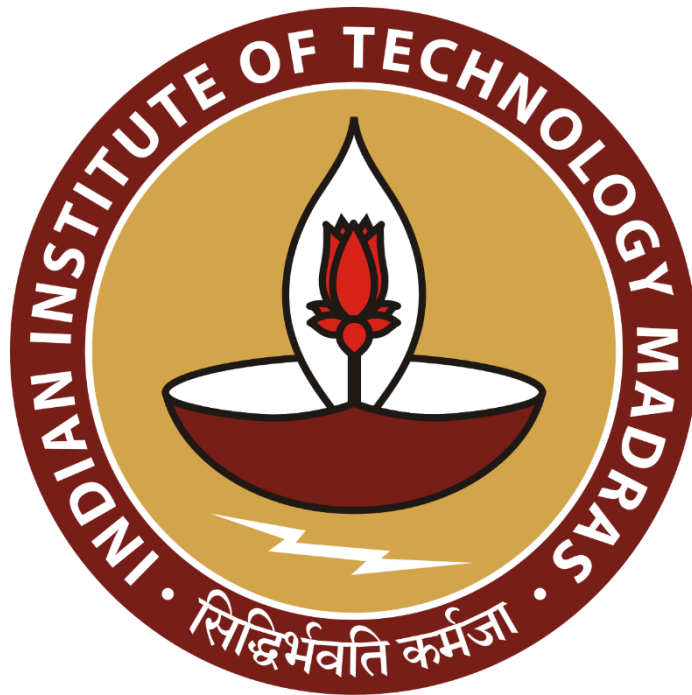
Analysis of Sales Trends and Inventory Management in a Women's Ethnic Wear Business

A Proposal report for the BDM capstone Project

Submitted by

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Declaration Statement

I am working on a Project titled “**Analysis of Sales Trends and Inventory Management in a Women’s Ethnic Wear Business**”. I extend my appreciation to **Tulsi**, for providing the necessary resources that enabled me to conduct my project.

I hereby assert that the data presented and assessed in this project report is genuine and precise to the utmost extent of my knowledge and capabilities. The data has been gathered from primary sources and carefully analyzed to assure its reliability.

Additionally, I affirm that all procedures employed for the purpose of data collection and analysis have been duly explained in this report. The outcomes and inferences derived from the data are an accurate depiction of the findings acquired through thorough analytical procedures.

I am dedicated to adhering to the principles of academic honesty and integrity, and I am receptive to any additional examination or validation of the data contained in this project report.

I understand that the execution of this project is intended for individual completion and is not to be undertaken collectively. I thus affirm that I am not engaged in any form of collaboration with other individuals, and that all the work undertaken has been solely conducted by me. In the event that plagiarism is detected in the report at any stage of the project's completion, I am fully aware and prepared to accept disciplinary measures imposed by the relevant authority.

I understand that all recommendations made in this project report are within the context of the academic project taken up towards course fulfillment in the BS Degree Program offered by IIT Madras. The institution does not endorse any of the claims or comments.



Signature of Candidate:

Name: Naman Gupta

Date: 05/03/2026

1 Executive Summary and Title

Tulsi is an ethnic wear retail store located in New Market, Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh (462003). The Jain family started the store in March 2000 to offer quality ethnic wear for women. The store follows a B2C retail model and mainly sells readymade suits and dress materials.

The store faces a few everyday operational challenges. Competition from nearby clothing stores and online platforms makes it difficult to maintain steady profit margins. The store also faces inventory management challenges. Some products remain in stock for a longer time, while others sell out quickly. Managing daily tasks and distributing work among staff can also be challenging at times. These situations can affect the smooth functioning and overall workflow of the store.

This Business Data Management capstone project looks at the store's sales and customer data to better understand how the business works on a daily basis. The project will use Microsoft Excel to organize and review sales records, customer purchase patterns, and inventory details by studying this information, the project will try to find simple patterns in sales and understand which products customers prefer the most. These insights can help the store manage its inventory in a better way and support everyday business decisions. The overall goal of the project is to help the store run its operations more smoothly, use its resources more carefully, and continue serving customers while maintaining steady business performance in the local markets.

2 Organization Background

Tulsi is an ethnic wear store located in New Market, Bhopal, Madhya Pradesh (462003). The Jain family started the store in March 2000 to provide good-quality ethnic wear for women. The shop mainly sells readymade suits and dress materials (unstitched fabric). Over the years, Tulsi has gained regular customers by providing good products and helpful service.

Tulsi works with a team of five members, and family members remain involved in the day-to-day operations of the store. Their participation supports smooth functioning and

encourages direct interaction with customers, which helps the shop understand customer requirements more effectively.

This Business Data Management capstone project analyses the business data of Tulsi to understand its current operations. The study examines sales patterns, customer preferences, and product demand to gain useful insights. It also identifies challenges related to inventory management and daily operations. Based on this analysis, the project aims to support better decision-making and help Tulsi improve its operations while continuing to serve its customers effectively.

3 Problem Statement

- 3.1 **Inventory Management Challenges:** The store sometimes finds it difficult to maintain the right stock levels. Some products stay in inventory longer, while others sell out quickly.
- 3.2 **Competition from Offline and Online Stores:** Competition from nearby clothing shops and online platforms makes it harder to maintain steady sales and profit margins.
- 3.3 **Work Distribution in Daily Operations:** Managing daily tasks and distributing work among staff can occasionally be challenging and may affect the smooth running of the store.
- 3.4 **Limited Use of Business Data:** The store currently uses limited sales and customer data for planning, which can affect inventory and business decisions.

4 Background of the Problem

Tulsi is a women's ethnic wear retail store in New Market, Bhopal, where customer preferences and fashion trends change frequently. The growth of quick fashion trends and the presence of nearby clothing stores and online platforms have increased competition in the local market. Customers now have many choices and often expect new styles and designs. As

a result, the store needs to carefully plan its product selection and inventory to meet changing customer demand.

Inventory management is one of the key challenges for the store. Demand for ethnic wear often changes due to fashion trends, seasonal buying, and customer preferences. Because of this, some products remain in stock for a longer time, while others sell much faster. Another issue is that the store does not regularly maintain daily sales records in a structured way. This makes it difficult to clearly see which products sell frequently and which items move slowly. When sales are not tracked consistently, planning stock levels and making restocking decisions becomes more difficult.

Internal operational factors also contribute to the problem. The store manages daily activities such as sales handling, stock arrangement, and customer service within its existing staff structure. At times, organizing tasks and distributing work efficiently can affect the overall workflow. Understanding these internal and external factors is important for improving inventory planning, operational efficiency, and overall business performance.

5 Problem Solving Approach

5.1 Methods

To understand the issues faced by the store, the study will examine the available sales data and also observe daily store activities. Sales records will be reviewed to see how different products have been selling over a period of time. This can help identify items that sell more frequently and those that tend to remain in stock for longer durations. Looking at these patterns may also give a clearer idea of customer demand across different categories of ethnic wear.

Inventory details will also be reviewed to understand how products move within the store. This can help point out slow-moving products and items that may need more regular restocking. In addition to reviewing data, observing store activities can help understand customer behaviour and how customers interact with product displays.

Customer feedback will also be considered through brief conversations or simple surveys with customers visiting the store. These interactions can provide useful insights into

preferences related to styles, pricing, and product choices. Observing everyday store work may also highlight areas where task coordination among staff can be improved.

5.2 Data Collection

The study will gather data on product sales, pricing, inventory, and customer preferences. The information will include product categories, buying price, selling price, available inventory, and how often each product is sold. Looking at this data will help show which products sell more frequently and how different items perform in the store.

The study will also collect customer feedback through simple surveys or informal discussions in the store. This will provide insights into customer preferences, style choices, and expectations regarding pricing and product range.

In addition, the study will include observations inside the store to understand customer buying behaviour and product visibility. Observing daily store activities will also help understand how work is managed during regular operations. Together, these inputs will help relate sales performance, inventory management, and customer engagement.

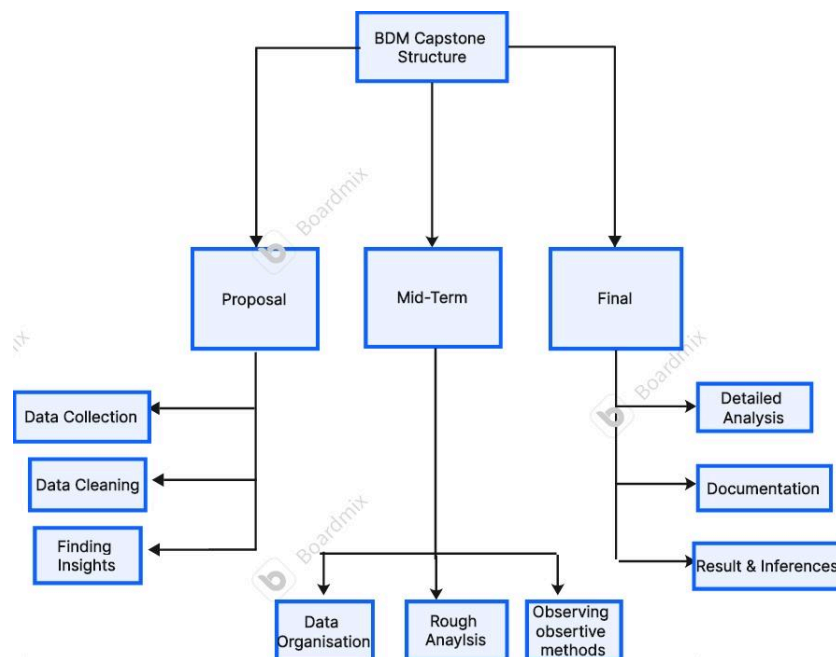
5.3 Analysis Tools

The study will use Microsoft Excel and Google Sheets to organise and analyse the collected data. These tools will help arrange sales and inventory information in clear tables so that it can be reviewed easily. Features such as sorting, filtering, pivot tables, and charts will be used to study sales frequency, pricing patterns, and product movement.

Charts and visual summaries will help present sales trends and product demand in a simple way. Excel and Google Sheets are selected because they are easy to use and widely applied for business data analysis. The results from this analysis will help the store understand product performance, improve inventory planning, and support better decision-making.

6 Expected Timeline

6.1 Work Breakdown Structure:



6.2 Gantt chart

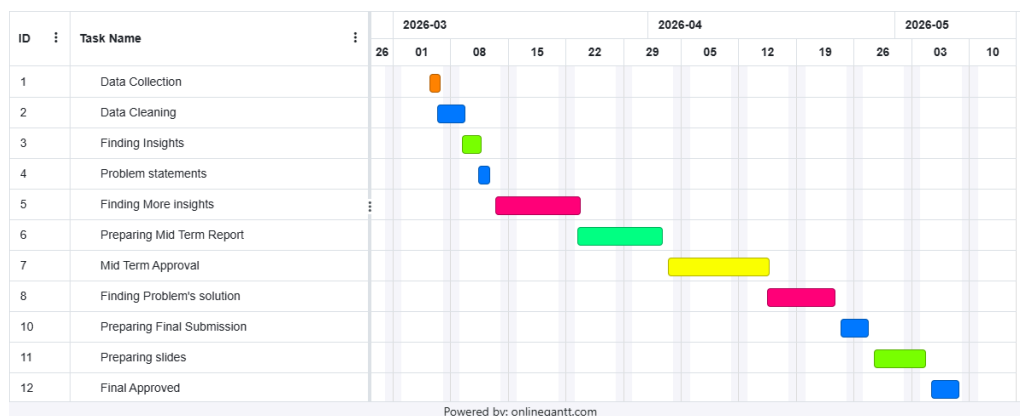


Figure 1 Expected timeline for completion of project.

Importance

A **Work Breakdown Structure** helps divide the project into smaller and manageable tasks. It ensures that all activities required for the project are clearly organised and planned.

A **Gantt Chart** shows the timeline of the project and helps track when each task should be completed. It also helps in managing time effectively and monitoring project progress.

7 Expected Outcome

- 7.1 The study can give us an idea of how much stock we should have for different products. This can help us keep our inventory levels balanced.
- 7.2 When we look at sales data we can see which products people like to buy. We can find out which categories or styles are popular with our customers.
- 7.3 When we combine sales data and customer feedback we can make choices about which products to sell. We can focus on the products that our customers want to buy.
- 7.4 Customer feedback can provide useful insights into what customers like or expect from the store. Their opinions about designs, prices, and product variety can help the store understand customer needs more clearly.
- 7.5 Observing daily store activities can help identify ways to manage tasks more smoothly and improve coordination among staff members.
- 7.6 The findings can support better planning for stocking products and making future business decisions based on sales and inventory data.
- 7.7 Insights from customer feedback and store observations can also help improve the overall shopping experience for customers visiting the store.